The fifth finish layer

Backdrop is a finish layer now.

The **recede** finish bakes a faint grid, a soft vignette, and a **backdrop clearance** — the grid reads at the margins and steps back behind the words, so the content sits on clean canvas.

The finish frames; the content stays clean.

The grid and vignette read at the edges. Where the body sits, the baked clearance recedes the finish — nothing competes with the message.

Spotlight — the inverse mask

Or reveal the finish in one window.

Clearance clears the center; **spotlight** does the opposite — it shows the finish in a single joystick-placed window and hides it everywhere else. Same mask, shaped the other way.

Legible over a live finish

61%

faster to skim

3x

less visual noise

AA

contrast held

One map overrides any baked layer

```
finish: finish-recede
finish-override:
  backdrop:
    strength: 0.4        # dim the whole finish
    clearance: off       # or turn the baked clearance off…
    spotlight: 74 34 40 # …and reveal one window instead (x y radius)
  texture:
    intensity: 4         # any layer is overridable
```

The Fabricate designer bakes the backdrop into the finish; `finish-override:` deep-merges over it and regenerates the finish CSS — in the Studio preview and every export.

the fifth finish layer — strength · clearance · spotlight

Restraint, baked in.

Tune the backdrop in Fabricate; override it per deck with one `finish-override:` map.